Chasing Sunsets At The End Of The World

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/54944887.

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Teen And Up Audiences

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Major Character Death

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by Moonii15

Summary

Two recently graduated young girls, Catra and Adora end up going on a summer road trip to Mystacor. They survive for as long as possible when lethal creatures invade the planet. The two girls thrive off the other's energy when the world has gone downhill.

Notes

CONTENT WARNING: This isn't a happy story, there is major character death involved and mentions of blood and gore. Read with caution!!

This is what I listened to while writing: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=-wfM_05ES1Y

See the end of the work for more notes

I

The sun was setting as the light spring air turned frosty. The young teens often had to huddle for warmth during evenings such as this one. Talking about any and everything; the things they missed- even school. The things they wondered if they still hated.

“I haven’t had one in so long…what if I like them now?” Catra wondered out loud.

Adora continued to run her calloused fingertips over the other girl's jeans; enjoying the smooth feeling of the few sparkly gems that still remained along the edges of her pockets.

“Well, one day…” She was doing that thing where she trailed off as she thought of a better future. Of someone rescuing them. Someone bringing them to a vivid island with civilization and fruits and vegetables, and people with smiling faces instead of bloodied ones.

“When we find our island. Our hope. I bet there will be tons and tons of tomatoes for you to try.”

Catra meets her eyes. Blue tourmaline and tigers eye to cloudy, baby blue calcite.

“And if I still hate it?”

The blonde locks their fingers together, remembering when she and Catra visited their city's love lock fence over a year ago. Remembering the warm summer sun coating their bodies in a searing glow. Remembering overlooking a beautiful, clear large body of water. It was called Eternias Link. Most lovers visited the area at least once- forever sealing their connection. Now it’s where people dump their loved ones after they couldn’t be saved…

She and Catra thought it would be fun to decorate their own lock. It sealed their friendship, saying that they didn’t care if they were forever alone, because they always had each other. They both knew deep down they wanted something more with the other.

“Then I’ll steal them off your sandwich and give you my pickles instead.” The two girls laughed, the sound quickly dying down as a somber atmosphere washed over them….

They were quickly losing their hope; all that was left was each other. They were low on supplies and knew it was only safest to go as soon as the sun rose.

II

A bird. A single bird was chirping nearby. The girls gazed at one another in amazement as it had been a long time since they’d heard or even seen a single animal. It was a high-pitched and

gracious sound full of spirit. Adora almost got out to rescue it. Catra stopped her and cradled her to her chest as there was a grating roar, one last shrill chirp, and the huge brawny creature swooped down and took its life in one go.

Adora's lungs burned as she cried until she could barely breathe, "Why, Cat, why!?"

Tears from the brunette's eyes made their way onto the blonde's head, seeping into her soul as a form of nourishment.

She caressed her soft skin, telling her it'd be okay. Telling her that the being would be better off if it didn't have to struggle to survive in this world.

Adora cried; Adora cried and Catra held her until she stopped and stared at the clear night sky, hollow and emotionless.

III

Catra missed their van. All of their stuff was in it. They brought a few light items with them in small satchels, making sure they'd be ready if their trip for supplies lasted longer than anticipated, but Catra *missed their van.*

It was a graduation gift from Adora's dad. He allowed them to go on a summer road trip to Mystacor together. He never let her go

out of the city alone. But he loved his daughter and she was growing up. He just wanted her to have fun. Catra never allowed Adora to let herself go down a familiar path of thought. The one where she wondered how much her parents worried. Where she cried herself to sleep hoping they never gave up on thinking about her.

As she walks down the long, cracked road, she can still remember the day they decorated it. It was two days after they attended a fellow friend's grad party. They covered it in stickers and painted it too. Adora filled it with fuzzy blankets and pillows; even adding both their favorite childhood stuffed animals. Melog and Swift Wind. All their friends thought they threw them out or put them in that stupid high school capsule thing. But they kept them. Something they did together.

Catra filled it with all their favorite snacks and Adora’s mother insisted they bring medicines and a few small first aid kits. Of course, Nana Razz couldn’t forget to bake them a pie for the trip. It was amazing. She wished she could relive that day a million times over if it meant avoiding this.

They sang songs and let the wind blow through their hair without a care in the world. Nothing mattered but the two of them.

It was that memory that helped Catra make it through the trip. Luckily, they found more food, some things to defend themselves, and some warmer clothes to combat the frigid nightly breeze.

They were almost back to their van. Catra could see it from their place down the road. They parked it where the sky was the clearest and watched every sunset and even some sunrises. They counted stars and wished on a few too. It barely registered in Catra's brain when they heard a quiet crackle of something in the nearby woods.

Adora paused before quickly grabbing Catra's arm and running them to the van. They couldn't take any risks. Not anymore. Catra was always the risk-taker. Always the one suggesting a sneak-out mission to the 24-hour minimart. Always the first to get a new piercing or explore new places. But those didn't matter anymore. Not when an even larger risk was involved.

Catra slammed the van door shut and they sunk low, hiding themselves beneath some blankets, weapons in hand. Neither girl could see outside of the van much, but they did hear someone calling for help. Their calls came out strained- it was hard not to tend to them. Both girls knew the drill by this point. Shutting their eyes tight and covering their ears as *it* came for the doomed individual.

They didn't hear the blood-curdling scream. Didn't hear the way their bones crunched between sharp teeth as they were devoured. They didn't see the blood *spatter* and *spill* onto the same road they had just been walking on moments earlier. They didn't carry any of it with them, not anymore. The emotional burden, that is.

After ten minutes of playing it safe. They looked up. The corpse was gone. Only a deep red streak of shimmering blood was left on the asphalt concrete.

It was later, when the nightfall came and the clear sky allowed a few glistening stars to shine when the girls were cuddled together once again.

Maybe, just maybe. It was time for Adora to be the risk-taker.

“Catra?” Her voice was quiet and hollow, devoid of her usual goofy spunk.

“Hm?” They were staring at each other now. Limbs twisted and connected as they submerged their entire bodies under a warm fuzzy blanket.

“I love you. With my entire being…and I needed to tell you this now because- because what if we don’t make it…”

“I love you too, Adora. You are my world and wherever you go, I’m going to be right there with you.”

Neither worried about the tears shed that night. It was all about the fiery and passionate kiss they shared. About how they somehow became closer and closer as it went on. Neither would forget the softness of the other's lips, or what fervid activities followed after.

It was as if that night was their only night of real living since the world turned to shit, descending into a horrid pit of chaos.

It was only the two of them. Always and forever.

A dance for two but the song was played by the creature that lurked and haunted them from afar…

IV

It's been days since Adora returned. She said she was just going to get them something to eat because they had gone so long without. She insisted Catra stay behind this time. The attacks had been getting stronger. Worse. She had only stayed because she made a promise to Adora. She couldn't break a promise. Not when the world was like this.

Catra was jolted awake. She had barely slept but began to nod off a bit ago. Adora was crawling into the van, clutching at her leg. Catra rushed to her side, helping her get comfy before examining the damage.

"It's just a few scrapes and probably a fracture. I'm going to be okay though! I fell on it when I was running." She sounded breathless and there was a tinge of *something* there.

Catra's heart clenched, "You scared me, Dor. I didn't know if you were coming back…" Her voice cracked towards the end and she didn't even try to hide how much it made her heart hurt to see her love this way.

Adora caressed her face and held her gaze, "I'll always come back for you."

They shared a sweet kiss before Catra helped her patch her scrapes. And she ignored the strange itch at the back of her mind that something was *very* wrong.

V

It never happened. Adora never came back. Catra's ~~*dumb and stupid mind*~~ played a trick on her. *Was it some kind of hallucination??* She was banging her head against the van walls in agony. All she could think was, ~~*stupid, stupid, stupid.*~~

Her breathing became rough as she stood and left the van. *Am I going ~~e crazy?~~ Next I'm going to start seeing Swift Wind and Melog as real-life animals.* She humorlessly laughed and scoffed to herself, making her way down the road.

By nightfall, she had searched almost every building. *She was going to find Adora. She had to.*

The sun was going to come up soon and there was only so much longer she could go without food. She found an old convenience store and entered without a thought. There was blood everywhere but she wasn't even phased by it at this point. She looked and looked and came up empty again. Catra howled in frustration, pushing a few random contents off of the checkout desk.

She spotted the back room behind the desk and made her way through. Dragging what was left of her hollowed-out, pale vessel. She gasped and stumbled back when she discovered a corpse. *Please don't be my Adora.*

She begged and pleaded to whoever was listening as she approached the pale blonde. She was lying on her side in a pool of blood, facing away from the door as if she *knew* Catra would find her like this. She didn't want Catra to see her like this.

It was her.

That same ponytail that was always messy these days. The old, tattered jean jacket that Catra used to steal from her closet. Beaten up red Converses and the ripped leggings she put on just before leaving a few days prior.

Catra screamed and cried and she beat her fist on the nearby wall. She *hurt* and *ached* as she held her lifeless lover. The only person who brought joy and light to her own life.

She prayed on her walk. Prayed that she was dreaming. That Adora would wake her up and hug her so tight that they couldn’t be separated. They were always described as a pair in the past anyway. Catra *and* Adora. You couldn't have one without the other.

They promised each other that they would go back to visit their lovelock. So that’s where Catra took her. It took a few more days, but she eventually made it. Adora wasn’t even heavy. They both had lost so much weight; She was cold and so, *so light.* She always let Catra on her back but it was time she returned the favor.

She sat there for a few hours. Resting with Adora’s head in her lap as she watched the murky water move and felt the cold metal of locks against her textured fingertips.

She knew she wouldn’t make it back. She didn’t even try. She laid out with Adora, caressing her skin and hair, running her finger over her smooth eyebrows. She mapped out the blonde's entire body before she discovered something shimmering under the moonlight, nearly falling out of the pocket of Adora’s jacket.

A golden locket. She took it out and found that there was a small note with a bloody fingerprint on it in her pocket as well. Tears fell from the brunette's dull, sunken eyes as she read it.

Catra. You are my everything. I couldn’t let you come with me because I knew it’d be too dangerous but I had to get this for you. I saw it the last time we were here but I couldn’t grab it

before we had to run again. It was still in a clear box and I knew it'd be perfect just for you. I love you, always and I hope I get to see you put it on. -A

She was hurt when she wrote this. She hoped she could make it back to her love. Even if she died after. Catra put the necklace on, felt the smooth texture between her fingers for a moment longer. She couldn't take it anymore. She needed a world with Adora in it and if she couldn't have that, then she had nothing. Adora was her sun and her moon. Her brain and heart. Her oxygen and lungs. Adora was *her* everything.

Catra cradled Adora close to her chest as she let out the most painful scream her body would let her.

After what felt like days. Her body was too weak to survive any longer. She lay with her lover as she took her last breath. Shutting her eyes slowly with the image of a smiling blonde girl behind her eyelids.

FIN

End Notes

I had a crazy itch to write something really sad. So I listened to sad instrumentals and this is where that got me. Please tell me what you think!

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!